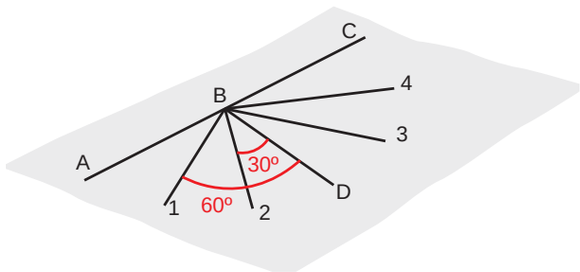
you shine light on the mirror from a torch light or sunlight, you will get a small ray of light. We can use this to study the properties of light.





Place a blank white sheet on a level ground out in the open. Choose a place where partly the sheet gets sunlight and partly it is in shadow. Hold the mirror with the slit facing the sun. You can see a straight ray of light reflected from the slit on the paper. Hold another mirror to reflect this ray. Observe well.

The light falling on the mirror is called as incident ray and the light reflected is called reflected ray..

Is there any relationship between the incident ray and reflected ray?

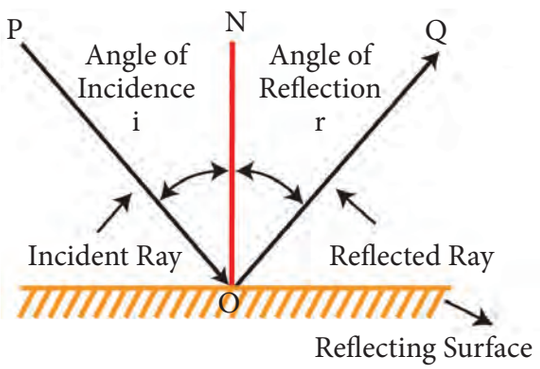
Draw a straight line ABC and angles as shown in the figure above. The line 1 is at 60° from BD, 2 at 30° from BD. Now , the line 4 at 60° from BD and line 3 at 30° from BD. The line BD is perpendicular, to ABC. Hold the mirror along the line ABC. Use the mirror with slit and make a ray go along the line 1 and reach the mirror at point B. Observe where the reflected ray is? Is the reflected ray go along 4?

Now, try keeping the mirror with slit and make the incident ray go along line 2. Now do we see that the reflected ray is along line 3?

Line BD, which is perpendicular the mirror surface is called as normal. The angle between the incident ray and the line BD is called angle of incident. Similarly, the angle between reflected ray and the normal is called as angle of reflection.

Can you make out relationship between the angle of incident ray and the angle of reflected ray? Yes. Is it not obvious that the angle of incident is same as the angle of reflection?

Terms used in reflection of light.



Incident ray: The ray of light that falls on the surface of the reflection materials. In figure, PO is the incident ray.

Reflected ray: The ray of light that comes from the point when the incident ray falls on the reflection material. In the figure, OQ is the reflected ray.

Point of incidence : The point of which are incident ray strikes the reflecting surface is the point of incidence. In the figure 'O' point of incidence.

Normal : The perpendicular line drawn from the point of incidence to the plane of reflecting surface is called normal. In figure, ON is the normal.

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